

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Social research methods and key sociology terms

Lecture 5.2

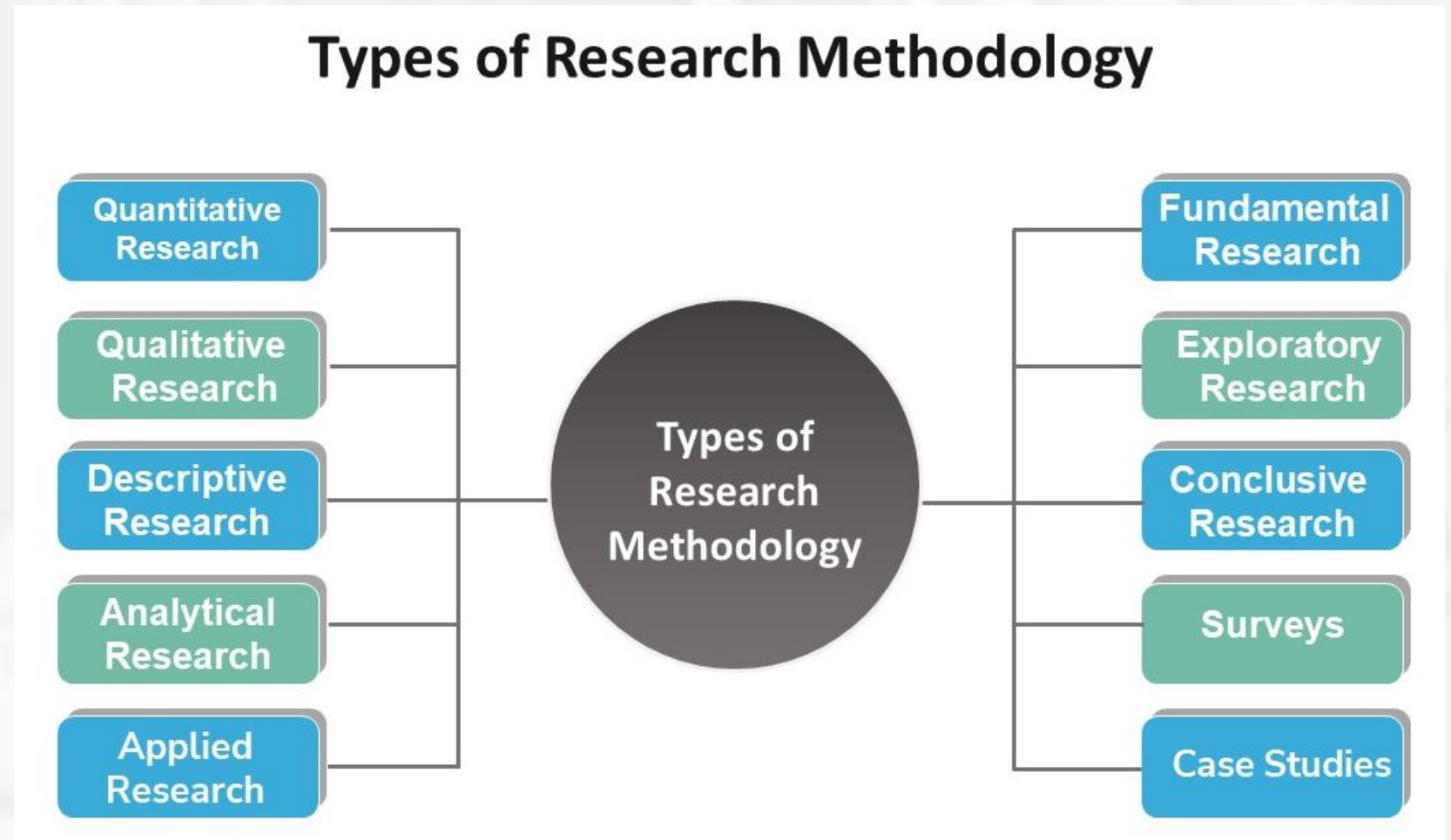
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Research

- Research is an original and systematic investigation undertaken to increase existing knowledge and understanding of the unknown to establish facts and principles.



Study Area



Surveys

- A survey collects data from subjects who respond to a series of questions about behaviors and opinions, often in the form of a questionnaire or an interview.
- The survey is one of the most widely used scientific research methods.
- The standard survey format allows individuals a level of anonymity in which they can express personal ideas.
- A survey targets a specific population, people who are the focus of a study.



CUSTOMER SATISFACTION SURVEY

1. Please tick a box on each line to indicate how much you rate level of service

	Excellent	Good	Average	Poor
a. Location	☐	☐	☐	☐
b. Comfort	☐	☐	☐	☐
c. Facilities	☐	☐	☐	☐
d. Staff	☐	☐	☐	☐
e. Value for money	☐	☐	☐	☐

2. Please tick a box on each line to indicate

	Excellent
a. Location	☐
b. Comfort	☐

- A common instrument is a questionnaire **closed-ended questions**.
- The researcher might ask yes-or-no or multiple-choice questions, allowing subjects to choose possible responses to each question.
- This kind of questionnaire collects **quantitative data**—data in numerical form that can be counted and statistically analyzed. (count up the number of “yes” and “no” responses or correct answers, and chart them into percentages).

The image shows two side-by-side questionnaire cards. The left card is titled 'CLOSED-ENDED' and contains a question 'What did you think of this piece?' with two radio button options: 'Great!' and 'Not what I needed'. The right card is titled 'OPEN-ENDED' and contains a question 'What would you need us to change?'. It includes a link to a help page and a text input field. An arrow points from the 'Not what I needed' option on the closed-ended card to the open-ended card, indicating that this option leads to a more detailed response.

CLOSED-ENDED

What did you think of this piece?

☐ Great!

☒ Not what I needed

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OPEN-ENDED

What would you need us to change? ★ PS: if you have a technical question, you'll likely find your answer at → <https://help.hotjar.com>

Please type here...

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Quantitative Data

(Numerical)

Age

Height

Weight

Income

University size

Group size

Self-efficacy test score

Percent of lecture attended

Clinical skills performed

Number of errors

- Questionnaires can also ask more complex questions with more complex answers—beyond “yes,” “no,” or checkbox options.
- These types of inquiries use **open-ended questions** that require short essay responses.
- Participants willing to take the time to write those answers might convey personal religious beliefs, political views, goals, or morals.
- The answers are subjective and vary from person to person. *How do you plan to use your college education?*

The image shows two side-by-side questionnaire cards. The left card is titled 'CLOSED-ENDED' and contains a question 'What did you think of this piece?' with two radio button options: 'Great!' (unselected) and 'Not what I needed' (selected). The right card is titled 'OPEN-ENDED' and contains a question 'What would you need us to change? 🌟 PS: if you have a technical question, you'll likely find your answer at → <https://help.hotjar.com>' followed by a text input field labeled 'Please type here...'. Both cards have a 'Next >' button and a link 'Not using Hotjar yet?' at the bottom. An arrow points from the 'Not what I needed' option on the left card to the open-ended question on the right card.

CLOSED-ENDED

What did you think of this piece?

☐ 🌟 Great!

☒ 🌟 Not what I needed

🔥 Not using [Hotjar](#) yet? [Next >](#)

OPEN-ENDED

What would you need us to change? 🌟 PS: if you have a technical question, you'll likely find your answer at → <https://help.hotjar.com>

Please type here...

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- Some topics that investigate internal thought processes are impossible to observe directly and are difficult to discuss honestly in a public forum.
- People are more likely to share honest answers if they can respond to questions anonymously.
- This type of personal explanation is **qualitative data**—conveyed through words.

Qualitative Data

(Categorical)

Gender

Religion

Marital status

Native language

Social class

Qualifications

Type of instruction

Method of treatment

Type of teaching approach

Problem-solving strategy used

Field Research

- The work of sociology rarely happens in limited, confined spaces.
- Rather, sociologists go out into the world. They meet subjects where they live, work, and play.
- Field research refers to gathering primary data from a natural environment.
- To conduct field research, the sociologist must be willing to step into new environments and observe, participate, or experience those worlds.
- In field work, the sociologists, rather than the subjects, are the ones out of their element.

